

JAGGAER CONTENT BRIEF

Grant Procurement Compliance in 2026: The Checklist Most NSF, NIH & Horizon Europe Teams Miss

BOFU · Geography: ALL · Target word count: 1,800–2,300 words · Primary ranking opportunity: grant procurement compliance checklist NSF NIH Horizon Europe (KD n/a for the exact stakeholder phrase; see Section 2 for real supporting-term data)

Brief at a glance

URL SLUG	/grant-procurement-compliance-checklist-2026
CONTENT TYPE	Checklist — Grant & Regulatory Compliance cluster anchor. First piece in this cluster; no spoke exists yet to link to or from.
TARGET WORD COUNT	1,800–2,300 words — a Checklist is scannable and category-led, not narrative; word count follows from how many real compliance categories earn a place.
TARGET AUDIENCE	Research administration and sponsored-programs compliance leads at institutions holding NSF, NIH, and/or Horizon Europe awards. BOFU: they're auditing their own process against a real framework, not learning what grant compliance is.
FUNNEL / GEO / PATH	BOFU · Geography: ALL · Publishing Week 3 (per project card)
PRIMARY KEYWORD	grant procurement compliance checklist NSF NIH Horizon Europe — stakeholder-specified, kept exactly as given. No exact-match MSV/KD was found; see Section 2 for the real supporting terms located instead. Drives H1/title/framing only.
SECONDARY KEYWORD	federal grant compliance university — stakeholder-specified, kept exactly as given. A close real-world variant ("federal grant compliance," 90 MSV) does exist — see Section 2.
PILLAR PAGE LINK	No Higher Education pillar page exists yet (same gap as the other two pieces already built in this pillar). As the cluster anchor, this piece has no existing spoke to link down to — see Section 5.
PUBLISH PRIORITY	High — cluster anchor; the underlying regulation is genuinely in motion (a May 2026 OMB proposed rule would rewrite the Uniform Guidance) — see stakeholder note.

1. Search intent analysis

The reader is a research administration or compliance lead who already manages NSF, NIH, or Horizon Europe awards and wants to know what a real, current compliance checklist covers — not a definition of grant compliance. BOFU: they're auditing their own institution's process, likely ahead of a Single Audit or a Horizon Europe grant preparation deadline.

What the reader needs to leave with

- A category-by-category checklist spanning both the US federal framework (2 CFR 200) and Horizon Europe's grant-preparation requirements — not just one system.
- Awareness that Uniform Guidance itself is being rewritten: a May 2026 OMB proposed rule would change indirect-cost preferences, termination rights, and international-collaboration rules.
- Confidence this is a fair checklist usable against any institution's process, not a sales pitch.
- A next step: how a unified platform operationalizes multi-framework compliance tracking.

SERP features to target

Featured snippet — a single sentence naming what this checklist covers (both US federal and Horizon Europe compliance in one place), directly under the H1. People Also Ask — FAQ section (Section 6) reframed around specific 2026 compliance questions.

Competitive intent note: CASRAI publishes an excellent, comprehensive federal grant compliance checklist (2 CFR 200, effort reporting, subawards) — but it's US-only, zero Horizon Europe coverage. Austria's FFG publishes real EU-side process detail (PIC/LEAR, financial capacity checks, Consortium Agreements) but nothing US-side. No source combines both systems in one checklist — that gap is this piece's opening. A University of Rochester notice on the pending 2026 Uniform Guidance rewrite is a current, citable source to reference directly.

STAKEHOLDER NOTE

A real OMB proposed rule (Federal Register, 29 May 2026) would rewrite the Uniform Guidance before this piece publishes: political pre-issuance review, "termination for convenience" with no appeal, and domestic-first restrictions. Comments closed 13 July 2026; final rule targeted 1 October 2026. Flag as pending, not settled, and review again once it finalizes.

2. Target keywords

Primary

KEYWORD	MSV	KD	INTENT
grant procurement compliance checklist NSF NIH Horizon Europe	—	—	Stakeholder-set primary — drives H1/title/framing, unchanged
federal grant compliance university	—	—	Stakeholder-set secondary — kept as-is, unchanged

Supporting — the real opportunity, found in the “federal grant compliance” batch

KEYWORD	MSV	KD	INTENT
federal grant compliance	90	14	Informational — real head term, best volume/difficulty ratio in either batch
federal grant compliance checklist	50	11	Informational — near-exact match for this piece's content type
managing subrecipient compliance multiple federal grants best practices	30	n/a	Informational — directly matches the subaward/consortium checklist category
uniform grant guidance procurement	20	n/a	Informational — points straight at 2 CFR 200, this piece's regulatory backbone
federal grant pre-award compliance requirements	20	n/a	Informational — matches the pre-award checklist category

Ultra-low KD callout: “federal grant compliance checklist” (50 MSV, KD 11) is the strongest real opportunity across both supplied batches — real volume, low difficulty, and a near-exact content-type match.

The 173-keyword “grant procurement” batch needed heavy trimming. “Grant” collides with proper nouns throughout: Grant Thornton (the consulting firm), Grant Street Group (a GovTech vendor), William Grant & Sons (the whisky company), and several named-individual/LinkedIn/legal-case entries. A further large share is hyper-local municipal budget-portal noise (Texas counties, a Georgia city council, Nevada, Pennsylvania) — a different audience (local government, not NSF/NIH/Horizon Europe research teams). Two 0-volume terms were kept despite no volume because they cite exact regulatory sections this checklist covers directly: “2 CFR 200.318 conflict of interest procurement federal grants” and “2 CFR 200.319 competition procurement federal grants.”

No corrections were made to the stakeholder-supplied primary/secondary keywords; no additional anchor terms were added beyond what's shown above.

3. Recommended page structure

ELEMENT	CONTENT GUIDANCE
H1 (Title)	Grant Procurement Compliance in 2026: The Checklist Most NSF, NIH & Horizon Europe Teams Miss (kept exactly as specified)
Meta title	Grant Compliance Checklist: NSF, NIH & Horizon EU — 55 characters
Meta description	A 2026 grant procurement compliance checklist covering NSF, NIH, and Horizon Europe requirements in one place. — 108 characters
Intro (100–150 words)	Snippet-ready: state plainly this checklist covers both the US federal framework and Horizon Europe in one place — most checklists cover only one. Work “federal grant compliance” in naturally.
H2: Pre-Award — Before You Accept the Money	NSF PAPPG / NIH Grants Policy Statement budget formatting; Horizon Europe’s PIC and LEAR validation and financial capacity check. Use “federal grant pre-award compliance requirements” naturally. Primary visual (Section 4) goes here.
H2: Cost Allowability & Indirect Costs	2 CFR 200 Subpart E allowability tests; NIH’s 15% indirect-cost-cap litigation status; F&A/MTDC basics. Use “uniform grant guidance procurement” naturally here.
H2: Screening, Conflicts & Ethics Review	SAM.gov exclusions and COI disclosure (2 CFR 200.318–200.319) on the US side; Declaration of Honour and ethics review/security scrutiny on the Horizon Europe side.
H2: Subrecipients & Consortium Management	Subrecipient classification and monitoring (US) vs. the Consortium Agreement and Accession Form process (Horizon Europe, 30-day window for late-joining partners). Use “managing subrecipient compliance multiple federal grants best practices” naturally.
H2: The 2026 Regulatory Shift to Watch	The pending May 2026 OMB proposed rule: political pre-issuance review, termination for convenience, domestic-first restrictions, publication-cost limits. Flag clearly as pending, not final. Secondary visual (Section 4) goes here.
H2: Closeout & Audit Readiness	3-year record retention (2 CFR 200.334), Single Audit triggers, and the three auditor severity tiers (control deficiency, significant deficiency, material weakness).
H2: FAQ	6–8 questions — see Section 6.
H2: Next steps	Link to the Public Sector cluster’s contract-leakage piece for the cross-vertical compliance angle, and to a compliance-tracking demo CTA (Section 5).

4. Visual production notes

Primary visual

A two-column checklist table: US federal requirement (2 CFR 200 citation) alongside its Horizon Europe equivalent, row by row (pre-award, cost allowability, screening/ethics, subrecipients/consortium, closeout). This is the piece's central asset. Appears within the first two scrolls.

Secondary visual (if applicable)

A “pending, not final” callout box specifically for the 2026 OMB proposed rule section — clearly dated, with the comment-period and target final-rule dates, so the piece doesn't read as settled fact. Appears under “The 2026 Regulatory Shift to Watch.”

Formatting notes: keep tables to 3-5 columns. Cite each 2 CFR 200 section directly beside its checklist item rather than in a footnote.

SIGN-OFF NEEDED

Confirm the OMB proposed rule's status before publish — it may have advanced, been withdrawn, or finalized between this brief and drafting. Do not name a specific JAGGAER compliance-tracking capability without product marketing confirmation.

5. Internal linking plan

DESTINATION	ANCHOR TEXT	PLACEMENT
Pillar page — Higher Education	Does not exist yet — TBC. First piece in this cluster.	Intro; Next steps
External — Federal Register, OMB proposed rule (29 May 2026)	“the proposed rule published in the Federal Register”	The 2026 Regulatory Shift to Watch
External — 2 CFR Part 200 (Uniform Guidance)	“the Uniform Guidance”	Cost Allowability; throughout
Product / CTA — JAGGAER compliance and spend tracking	“see how a unified platform tracks compliance across NSF, NIH, and Horizon Europe awards” (TBC pending confirmation)	Next steps

As the cluster anchor, this piece should accumulate inbound links as the Grant & Regulatory Compliance cluster grows — revisit this table once a spoke publishes.

6. FAQ targets

Each answer should be 2-3 sentences, written to target the PAA box. Answers must be self-contained — assume the reader may read only the FAQ.

- What is the Uniform Guidance (2 CFR Part 200), and why does it matter for NSF and NIH grants?
- What compliance steps does Horizon Europe require that US federal grants don't?
- What is changing in the proposed 2026 Uniform Guidance rewrite?
- What is a PIC and a LEAR in Horizon Europe, and why are they required before signing?
- How does subrecipient monitoring differ from Horizon Europe consortium management?
- What triggers a Single Audit, and how should an institution prepare?
- How long must federal grant records be retained after closeout?

7. SEO and technical requirements

URL	/grant-procurement-compliance-checklist-2026 (no date beyond the year — treat as a snapshot piece, not fully evergreen)
Title tag	Grant Compliance Checklist: NSF, NIH & Horizon EU — 55 characters
Meta description	A 2026 grant procurement compliance checklist covering NSF, NIH, and Horizon Europe requirements in one place. — 108 characters
Schema markup	Article + FAQPage schema on the FAQ section.
Update cadence	High — review immediately once the OMB proposed rule is finalized, withdrawn, or substantially revised, and whenever the EU publishes a new Horizon Europe work programme.
Canonical	Self-canonical. Plan a full refresh once the OMB rule's status resolves — the “2026 Regulatory Shift to Watch” section will need updating regardless of outcome.
Disclaimer	Recommended: note that this checklist is a general compliance-orientation framework, not a substitute for legal or grants-management review of any specific award, and that the 2026 rule discussed was proposed, not final, at time of publication.

8. Recommended sources

List only primary sources: official documentation, regulatory text, government publications, peer-reviewed research, or official organization guidance.

- Federal Register — “Regulation for Federal Financial Assistance” proposed rule (published 29 May 2026) — the primary source for the pending 2026 Uniform Guidance rewrite; verify current status directly before publishing, as the comment period and rule status will have moved on.
- 2 CFR Part 200 (eCFR / OMB Uniform Guidance) — the current regulatory backbone for cost allowability, pre-award, post-award, and audit requirements referenced throughout.
- University of Rochester, Office of the Vice President for Research — institutional summary of the proposed rule (4 June 2026, fetched and reviewed directly) — useful for the plain-language framing of what the proposed rule changes, cross-checked against the Federal Register text.
- FFG (Austrian Research Promotion Agency) — “Grant preparation in Horizon Europe” (fetched and reviewed directly) — the source for PIC/LEAR validation, financial capacity checks, and Consortium Agreement process detail.
- European Commission Funding & Tenders Portal — official Horizon Europe reference documents and work programmes; verify current call-specific requirements directly before citing specifics.

Source note: CASRAI's own federal grant compliance checklist is a genuinely strong, comprehensive competitor resource (not cited above, since it's a competitor's content, not a primary regulatory source) — its structure confirmed this piece's US-side categories are sound, and confirmed the gap: CASRAI has no Horizon Europe coverage at all. Several supplied links (a LinkedIn post, a ScienceBusiness work-programme PDF, an AI grant-checklist agent tool, a proposal-checklist vendor page, and the EC's live call-listing portal) were not independently fetched for this brief — recommend the writer check the EC portal and the ScienceBusiness PDF directly for the most current Horizon Europe work-programme specifics, since those move faster than this brief's research window.

This brief was generated from keyword data with no exact match for the stakeholder-set primary/secondary phrases; real supporting terms were located in a related “federal grant compliance” batch (see Section 2). This document is not legal advice.